residual part of the current year. The targeted BPL cardholders will be as estimated by the Department of Food and Public Distribution.

v. The Scheme for Distribution of Subsidized Imported Edible Oils has been implemented since 2008-9 through state/union territory (UT) governments for distribution of 1 litre per ration card per month with a central subsidy of Rs 15 per kg. The scheme has been extended up to 30 September 2013.

4. Budgetary and other Measures

i. A number of measures were announced in Union Budget 2012-13 to augment supply and improve storage and warehousing facilities. The government launched a National Mission for Protein supplements in 2011-12 with an allocation of Rs 300 crore. To broaden the scope of production of fish to coastal aquaculture, apart from fresh water aquaculture, the outlay in 2012-13 was stepped up to Rs 500 crore. Recently the government permitted FDI in multibrand retail trading. This will help consumers and farmers as it will improve the selling and purchasing facilities.

5. Monetary Measures

i. The RBI had also taken suitable steps to contain inflation with 13 consecutive increases by 375 basis points (bps) in policy rates from March 2010 to October 2011.

IMG ON INFLATION

An Inter-Ministerial Group (IMG) on inflation was set up on 2 February, 2011, on the recommendation of the Prime Minister, under the Chairmanship of Chief Economic Adviser, Ministry of Finance to review the overall inflation situation, *with particular reference* to primary food articles. Upto February 2013, the IMG had eight meetings covering various aspects, including information system on all aspects of price monitoring, Foreign Direct Investment (FDI) in *multi-brand retail*, reform in APMC